

Validation passes per manifest

1. File exists at canonical path (helix-deps.yaml preferred; .json / .toml accepted)
2. schema_version: 1 declared
3. deps: top-level array present
4. transitive_handling: block present

(Deeper schema validation — per-dep name/ssh_url/ref/why/layout field-level checks — is owed to a follow-up enhancement; current scanner uses a structural grep-based fallback that catches the most common drift class without requiring `yq` / `python-yaml` toolchain.)

Modes

Flag	Behavior
<code>--strict</code> (default)	Exit 1 on any violation
<code>--advisory</code>	Exit 0 even on violation
<code>LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0</code> env	Same as <code>--advisory</code>

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh           # strict
              (default)
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh --advisory # exit 0
              even on violation
LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-helix-deps-
manifest.sh    # env-driven
```

Hermetic test

tests/check-constitution/test_helix_deps_manifest.sh — 6 fixtures:

1. `test_compliant_fixture_passes` — parent + per-submodule manifests both present + well-formed
2. `test_missing_parent_manifest_rejected` — repo root lacks helix-deps.yaml
3. `test_missing_submodule_manifest_rejected` — owned submodule lacks helix-deps.yaml
4. `test_wrong_schema_version_rejected` — `schema_version: 999` (must be 1)

5. `test_advisory_mode_returns_zero` — advisory swallows exit code
6. `test_json_variant_accepted` — discrimination test: `helix-deps.json` is recognized as a valid alternative extension

Known violations (2026-05-15 audit)

Parent manifest: `helix-deps.yaml` (well-formed, declares 17 deps: 16 vasic-digital submodules + constitution).

Per-submodule manifests: 16 of 16 owned submodules MISSING `helix-deps.yaml`.

Submodule	Status
Auth, Cache, Challenges, Concurrency, Config, Containers, Database, Discovery, HTTP3, Mdns, Middleware, Observability, RateLimiter, Recovery, Security, Tracker-SDK	✗ MISSING — owed in per-submodule follow-up commits

Resolution path: per-submodule cycle (write `helix-deps.yaml` → commit to submodule → push to GitHub + GitLab per §6.W → bump pin in parent Lava). The parent commit can batch the 16 pin bumps once each submodule has its own manifest. Then sweep wrapper flips from advisory → strict.

Cross-references

- `HelixConstitution Constitution.md §11.4.31` (the mandate)
- `docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md` Phase 3
- `docs/helix-constitution-gates.md` CM-HELIX-DEPS-MANIFEST row
- `scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh` (wraps this scanner per §11.4.32)
- Lava parent's reference manifest: `helix-deps.yaml` (declares all 16 submodule deps + constitution)

2026-05-15 update — HelixQA waiver

Phase 4 of the constitution-compliance plan adopted submodules/`helixqa` (HelixDevelopment-owned QA orchestration framework) at upstream HEAD `403603db`. `HelixQA's CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / CONSTITUTION.md` follow the canonical-root

INHERITED FROM Helix Constitution pointer pattern

(HelixDevelopment-authored) rather than Lava's heading-anchored §6.R / §6.S / §6.X / §6.AD pointer-block format. HelixQA also lacks helix-deps.yaml + install_upstreams.sh wrapper script.

Resolution: HELIX_DEV_OWNED=("HelixQA") waiver list + is_helix_dev_owned() helper skip HelixQA in every per-Submodule loop in this scanner. Waiver entries cite Phase 4-debt: PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream owed to add the missing files. Once upstream merges + Lava's pin advances to include them, HelixQA can be removed from the waiver list.

2026-05-16 update — HelixQA waiver RESOLVED

The Phase 4-debt PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream landed as commit b13ba7c (feat(gov): add helix-deps.yaml + install_upstreams.sh wrapper), adding both missing files at HelixQA's repo root. Lava's pin advanced to b13ba7c in the same parent commit that removed HelixQA from HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS. The waiver list is now empty — the per-Submodule loop in this scanner treats HelixQA on equal terms with the other 16 owned submodules; all 17 must ship a parseable helix-deps.yaml at the submodule root or the scanner reports a violation. The HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS=() empty array is intentionally retained as a forensic anchor.

2026-09-19 update — PERMANENT superspec waiver (third-party, not a debt item)

submodules/superspec (upstream github.com/WangX0111/superspec, consolidated onto the project's standard submodules/ path this same day per an operator decision — see scripts/check-constitution.sh's companion doc for the sibling THIRD_PARTY_OWNED fix, commit 80b1bb2c) tripped §11.4.31 the moment it entered the submodules/*/ scan: it is not a vasic-digital or HelixDevelopment repo, so there is no upstream Lava can PR a helix-deps.yaml manifest into — unlike the HelixQA case above, this is not a debt item awaiting an upstream merge; it is a structural non-applicability. Added "superspec:..." to HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS with a rationale citing this. Falsifiability rehearsed: removing the waiver entry reproduces Submodules missing helix-

`deps.{yaml,json,toml}: superspec verbatim; restoring it passes again.`
This waiver is expected to remain indefinitely — there is no resolution path to track, unlike the now-empty HelixQA entry above.